

Customer Service Policy

Document owner: Customer Experience

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines how Harbor & Pine Outfitters handles common customer service requests received by email. It covers order cancellations, damaged or defective product complaints, and the return of delivered goods. It also defines when a request must be escalated to a human agent.

This policy applies to all consumer orders placed through the Harbor & Pine online store. It does not cover wholesale or business-to-business orders, which follow a separate agreement.

2. Order Cancellations

2.1 Eligibility

A customer may cancel an order while it is still in the processing status and has not yet been handed to the carrier. An order is eligible for cancellation when all of the following are true:

- the order status is processing;
- the order has not been marked as shipped (no ship date is recorded);
- the cancellation request is received within 24 hours of the order being placed.

2.2 Orders that cannot be cancelled

An order is not eligible for self-service cancellation once any of the following applies:

- the order has been shipped, delivered, or returned;
- the order has already been cancelled;
- more than 24 hours have passed since the order was placed.

Orders that have shipped should be handled as a return after delivery (see Section 4) rather than a cancellation.

2.3 Outcome

When an order is cancelled, no charge is captured, or any pending charge is voided. If a payment was already captured, the cancellation is processed as a refund under the Billing Policy.

3. Damaged or Defective Products

3.1 Eligibility

A customer may report a damaged or defective item when:

- the order status is delivered;
- the report is made within 30 days of the delivery date;
- the customer describes the damage or defect.

3.2 Evidence

For most claims a written description of the damage is sufficient. For high-value items (line value of 150 USD or more), a photograph of the damage should be requested before a replacement or refund is approved.

3.3 Outcome

Approved damage claims are resolved by a free replacement of the same item where stock is available, or a full refund of the affected line where it is not. Refunds follow the Billing Policy.

4. Returns of Undamaged Goods

A customer may return an undamaged, unused item within 30 days of delivery for a refund. The item must be in resalable condition. Return shipping for undamaged goods is paid by the customer unless the return is the result of a Harbor & Pine error.

Items marked as final sale or discontinued may be returned only if they arrived damaged or defective.

5. Escalation to a Human Agent

A request must be escalated to a human agent when any of the following is true:

- the request does not match a supported workflow (cancellation, damaged item, invoice question, or product availability);
- required information cannot be found in the customer's email or in business data;
- the order or invoice referenced by the customer cannot be located;
- a damage claim falls outside the 30-day window;
- the customer disputes a previous decision or requests a goodwill exception;
- the request involves suspected fraud or a legal complaint.

Escalated cases are routed to the customer service queue with the case context and the reason for escalation attached.

6. Response Standards

- Replies must be accurate and grounded in business data and approved policy.
- Replies must not invent order details, prices, dates, or policy terms.
- Replies should be polite, concise, and written in plain language.
- When a request is escalated, the customer should be told that a human agent will follow up, without promising a specific outcome.

7. Privacy

Personal data is masked before any automated language processing takes place. Customer contact details are used only to locate the relevant order or invoice and to respond to the request.